increasing manufacturing capabilities in order to meet demand.' Although he allowed a ban for a limited period of time,[9] he asked Mandaviya and other officials to get in touch with manufacturers of the drug in India, map out our requirement in the worst-case scenario, find a way to bring all stakeholders together, scale up manufacturing and look at the timelines of such an exercise. He instructed the officials to ensure that no bureaucratic hold-up came in the way of increasing production to meet demands not just of India's but of other countries as well. Once again, deriving from his experience in Gujarat, which is also a manufacturing hub of the pharmaceutical industry, the prime minister had a rough idea of the processes which would be needed to significantly scale up production and he was aware that this would not be an impossible task to accomplish. After the meeting at his residence, he reached out to Pankaj Patel, Cadila Healthcare's CEO, to urge him to increase manufacturing as soon as possible. Just in a fortnight, Patel would say to the media, 'PM Modi motivated the industry by saying this is the chance for India to make a mark globally and the results are for all to see. This month our industry produced twenty crore tablets. My company alone will produce active pharmaceutical ingredients (APIs) worth fifteen crore tablets next month.'[10]

It took about a week for the officials to report back to the prime minister that India would be able to quickly scale up production to suffice not only internal requirements but also be able to meet new demands arising from other countries. With that information, the ban on HCQ was lifted[11] and India began to supply it to several countries initiating its crucial role during the COVID-19 years as the 'pharmacy of the world'. Several world leaders also appreciated India's timely help in HCQ supply. President Trump, on a phone call with the prime minister, said, 'We'd appreciate you allowing our HCQ supply to come out.'[12] A few days later, the President of Brazil Jair Bolsonaro tweeted a thank you note for the prime minister with an image of Lord Hanuman carrying Sanjeevani.[13]

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**26 MARCH 2020**

INDIA | 727 ACTIVE CASES | 21 DEATHS

WORLD | 4,80,180 ACTIVE CASES | 25,367 DEATHS